

SEBASTIAN N. OLMSTED

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Nairobi, Kenya

EDUCATION

(2022 – 2026)

**UNIVERSITY OF
CALIFORNIA, SANTA
BARBARA (UCSB)**

B.A. in Anthropology,
emph. Archaeology

(2025)

**UNIVERSITY OF
BOLOGNA**

University of California
Education Abroad
Program

SKILLS

Field skills

- Free-hand sketching, site plan drawing, section profiles, artifact/object illustrations, and reconstructions.
- Total station operation
- Site and landscape digital scanning (LiDAR)
- Auger coring (manual)
- Flotation/screening methods of recovery
- Biological sample collection

Data/digital skills

- GIS (QGIS, ArcGIS) coding, encompassing visibility analyses, DEM simulations, site mapping, data overlay/extrapolation.
- Basic coding in R and Python
- Website construction

UC Santa Barbara graduate specializing in landscape and medieval archaeology, with a core focus on the dynamic interactions between human communities, ecology, and the built environment. My work bridges empirical scientific foundations—including behavioral ecology, spatial analysis, and material laboratory analysis—with humanistic, phenomenological approaches to landscape. Having supported field investigations and artifact analysis spanning historic fortifications to prehistoric settlements, I am currently dedicating a gap year to intensive research writing and field projects in preparation for graduate study.

FIELDWORK EXPERIENCE

NGOGO MONKEY PROJECT | RESEARCH ASSISTANT, UCSB

June–September 2026 • Kibale National Park, Uganda

- Collected behavioral data over three months across three habituated wild red-tailed monkey (*C. ascanius*) groups, focusing on adult females' participation in simulated intergroup engagements (IGEs).
- Collected and processed urine and fecal samples for DNA and hormone analysis at the University of Minnesota.

CERVIA VECCHIA EXCAVATION | UNIVERSITY OF BOLOGNA

June–July 2025 • Emilia-Romagna, Italy

- Conducted stratigraphic excavation, artifact recovery and cataloguing, as well as drawn and photographic documentation of a medieval coastal settlement.
- Contributed to identifying the eastern extent of a defensive wall and supported public outreach.

SALVAGE ARCHAEOLOGY CAMPAIGN | LECCE NEI MARSÌ

August 2024 • Abruzzo, Italy

- Assisted with emergency excavation of three Roman-era tile-covered (cappuccina-style) burials discovered during pipeline construction.
- Recovered and catalogued human remains and prepared materials for transfer to the Italian Ministry of Culture for bioarchaeological analysis.

NEOLITHIC EXCAVATION | UNIVERSITY OF PISA

July–August 2024 • Lecce nei Marsi, Abruzzo, Italy

- Excavated and recovered faunal remains, microliths, botanical materials, pottery, and ochre from an early central Italian Neolithic settlement.
- Used total station surveying, 3D scanning, photographic recording, screening, and flotation to document the site and recover materials.

Laboratory skills

- Fluid sampling and hormone testing (ELISA tests, DNA extraction)
- Basic ceramic usewear analysis

Soft skills

- Public speaking and presentation
- Both large and small project organization and coordination
- Cataloguing, record-keeping, and efficient organizational skills

AWARDS

Award for Research Promise (2026) – Issued by the UC Santa Barbara Department of Anthropology

2nd Annual UCSB Anthropology Research Symposium Award (2026) – Issued by the UC Santa Barbara Department of Anthropology Symposium committee for the Scaliger Castle Research Project

Certificate of Appreciation (2024) – Awarded on behalf of U.S. ambassador to Peru Syptak-Ramnath for my work at HR

Certificate of Appreciation (2023) – Awarded on behalf of the USAID Peru Environmental and Sustainable Growth (ESG) Office.

LANGUAGES

English (fluent)

Italian (fluent)

Spanish (intermediate)

LAB EXPERIENCE

CERAMICS ANALYSIS LAB | RESEARCH ASSISTANT

January 2023–June 2026 • University of California, Santa Barbara

- Identified, catalogued, illustrated, and reconstructed Nubian ceramics from Askut and Tombos under Professor Stuart Tyson Smith.
- Managed digital collection records and prepared research materials for conference presentations.

ENDOCRINOLOGY LAB | LABORATORY TRAINING

September–December 2024 • University of California, Santa Barbara

- Trained in fluid sample collection and preparation, pipetting, vortex mixing, incubation, and measurement under Nicole Thompson Gonzales.
- Maintained laboratory records and datasets and developed a research proposal addressing endocrinological methods in biological anthropology.

RESEARCH

SCALIGER CASTLE VIEWSHED INDEPENDENT RESEARCH PROJECT

2025–2026 • University of California, Santa Barbara

- Conducted a research award-winning GIS study of 12 late medieval fortifications associated with the Della Scala (Scaliger) lords of Verona (IT), using viewshed, cumulative visibility, and randomized spatial analyses to assess the validity of defensive and symbolic interpretations in medieval castle literature.
- Presented findings through an independent study and lightning talk.

WORK EXPERIENCE

U.S. EMBASSY, LIMA | HUMAN RESOURCES INTERN

August–September 2024 • Lima, Peru

- Managed personnel records and payment spreadsheets and supported embassy events and website updates.
- Assisted with interagency planning and logistics for the presidential pre-advance ahead of the 2024 APEC Summit.

USAID PERU | ENVIRONMENTAL OFFICE INTERN

July–September 2023 • Lima, Peru

- Led a two-month research project on irregularities in carbon credit initiatives in the Peruvian Amazon; presented findings to USAID's Environmental and Alternative Development Offices.
- Supported program documentation, conference coordination, and site visits with Peru's Ministry of the Environment.